

Mohammad Hossein Eslami

CURRICULUM VITAE

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EDUCATION

Sep 2019 – Jan 2023	M.A. in Theatre Directing <i>Tehran University of Art, Tehran, Iran</i> Thesis: A Study of the Representation of Identity in the Work of Elizabeth LeCompte Practical thesis: <i>Maid to Marry</i> , after Eugène Ionesco Advisors: Prof. Kamran Sepehran, Prof. Esmaeil Shafiee GPA: 4.0 / 4.0 (18.42 / 20)
Sep 2013 – Sep 2018	B.Sc. in Software Engineering <i>Shahid Beheshti University, Tehran, Iran</i> Final project: <i>The Rock</i> , an animation based on Albert Camus's <i>The Myth of Sisyphus</i> Advisor: Prof. Ahmad Ali Abin
2009 – 2013	Diploma in Mathematics and Physics <i>Salam High School, Tehran, Iran</i>

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Postdramatic Theatre	Intermediality Studies
Political Theatre	Gender and Queer Studies

PUBLICATIONS

Manuscript in progress	Eslami, M. H., & Sepehran, K. Theatrical Trial: Elizabeth LeCompte's Artistic Inquiry into Identity in <i>The Emperor Jones</i> and <i>To You, the Birdie!</i>
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HONOURS & AWARDS

2019	Ranked 3rd nationally, Master's Entrance Examination (Theatre Directing)
2013	Top 1%, National University Entrance Examination
2010	Semi-finalist, National Literature Olympiad

THEATRE WORK

2026	<i>Mephisto For Ever</i> <i>Director, Producer & Scene Designer, Labkhand Theatre Complex, Tehran, Iran</i> - Based on Tom Lanoye's play and Klaus Mann's novel <i>Mephisto</i>; in rehearsal, opening November 2026. - Metatheatrical staging of a troupe performing itself, combining classical and modern acting, puppetry, contemporary dance and video mapping. - Designed a modular set of one-metre cubes, a trussed arch and a stepped platform, and a plexiglass puppet stage; key sequences previsualised in 3D.
Nov 2024	<i>Mixed Sandwich</i> <i>Media Producer & Media Projection Coordinator, Tehran, Iran</i> - Independent production directed by Mohammad Hossein Heshmati and Aref Hassanzadeh. - Produced the media content and coordinated projection during performances.
2022	<i>The Good Person of Szechwan</i> <i>Scene Designer, Mehregan Theater, Tehran, Iran</i> - Set design for Bertolt Brecht's play, directed by Masoud Jahandideh. - Designed a wooden stage floor tuned to produce specific sounds under the actors' movement, and lightweight props for fast scene changes in view of the audience.
2018	<i>In Front of City Theater</i> <i>Director & Co-Scene Designer, Neauphle-le-Château Theater, Tehran, Iran</i>

- Four-episode play by Salman Alighardashi on the life of Sohrab A'raabi, drawing on the myth of Rostam and Sohrab in Ferdowsi's *Shahnameh*.
 - Year-long process with a company of fifteen; choreography drawn from Pina Bausch's trust exercises; five original songs mixing alternative rock and Persian folk music.
 - Co-designed with Mohsen Khamechian a metal set that opens like the pages of a pop-up book.
- 2017 ***Saturday Nights (concert performance)***
Actor & Co-Choreographer, Independent Theater of Tehran, Iran
- With Farnoosh Azor, choreographed eight dance pieces and two short plays staged around the music of the rock band Padir.
- 2016 ***Asgardia***
Director & Co-Playwright, Mashayekhi Theater Hall, Tehran, Iran
- Co-written with Reyhane Yazdani: six strangers on a mission to the first nation in space, intercut with a mythic line drawn from the story of Adam and Eve.
 - Built the company from scratch; a 14-month devising process with eleven actors, most of them performing professionally for the first time.
- 2015 ***A Requiem for Oedipus***
Actor (Chorus), Shahid Beheshti University, Tehran, Iran
- Student production directed by Abtin Gholampour with the university's theatre association and philosophy society; the chorus was reduced to four performers after research on the chorus in Sophocles.

ACADEMIC PRODUCTIONS

- 2023 ***Maid to Marry***
Director (practical MA thesis), Tehran University of Art
- Based on Eugène Ionesco's short absurdist play, reworked around identity and education; supervised by Prof. Esmaeil Shafiee.
 - Three simultaneous layers: a "cyber" version of the script on monitors, the play on stage, and seven teenagers performing as themselves; approach drawn from Elizabeth LeCompte's use of source texts as raw material.
- 2022 ***King Lear***
Actor, Tehran University of Art
- Final project of the Advanced Directing 2 course, directed by Hojjat Salimi.
- 2021 ***King Lear***
Director, Tehran University of Art
- Final project of the Advanced Directing 2 course, led by Prof. Esmaeil Shafiee.
 - Eight versions of the storm scene, each testing a different directorial element (light, staging, mise-en-scène), combined into one final performance.
- 2021 ***The Bear***
Director, Tehran University of Art
- Final project of the Advanced Directing 1 course, led by Prof. Esmaeil Shafiee.
 - Online performance of Anton Chekhov's play combining animation and live acting, made during the COVID-19 pandemic.
- 2020 ***The Proposal***
Director, Tehran University of Art
- Final project of the Principles of Directing course, led by Prof. Esmaeil Shafiee.
 - Staged Chekhov's text without cuts or additions, using the physical vocabulary of commedia dell'arte.

ACADEMIC WRITING

- 2021 ***A Critical Analysis of Florian Zeller's The Father***
Final paper, Play Analysis course, Prof. Kamran Sepehran
- 2020 ***Yuri Lotman's Semiosphere in Noah Baumbach's Marriage Story***
Final paper, Semiotics course, Prof. Ramtin Shahbazi

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- 2016 – 2018 **Mahtaab Digital Marketing Agency**
Art Director, Tehran, Iran
- Art direction for video advertisements and events.

WORKSHOPS & TRAINING

- 2023 **Dramaturgy Workshop**
Farvardin Playwriting School, Tehran, Iran
- With Keivan Sarreshte: the history and styles of dramaturgy, and adapting classical texts for contemporary performance.
- 2021 – 2022 **Advanced Playwriting Course**
Farvardin Playwriting School, Tehran, Iran
- Fifteen-month course with twelve practising theatre-makers, including Mohammad Charmshir, Erfan Nazer and Mohammadreza Aliakbari.
- 2021 **Drama and Performance Workshop**
Farvardin Playwriting School, Tehran, Iran
- With Mohammadreza Aliakbari: acting and directing techniques after Meyerhold, Eugenio Barba's methods, and the Theatre Workshop of Tehran and the Shiraz Arts Festival in the 1970s.
- 2021 **Personality Psychology in Playwriting**
Farvardin Playwriting School, Tehran, Iran
- With Azimeh Sattari: psychological analysis of dramatic characters, including personality disorders in well-known plays.
- 2015 – 2018 **Contemporary Dance**
Private classes with Nima Hosseinzadeh, Tehran, Iran
- Contemporary dance, body movement and choreography.
- 2016 **Theatre Facing Society Workshop**
Tehran University Experimental Theatre Center, Tehran, Iran
- With Christoph Pauger: applied and pedagogical theatre with marginalised communities.

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Theatre	Directing, Playwriting, Scene Design, Dramaturgy, Theatre Pedagogy
Film & Media	Screenwriting, Editing, Videography, 3D Previsualisation
Software	Final Cut Pro, Adobe Premiere Pro, Adobe After Effects, Adobe Audition, Apple Motion, Previs Pro
Languages	Persian (native) · English (IELTS Academic 8.0: Listening 8.5, Reading 8.5, Writing 7.0, Speaking 7.0) · Arabic (basic)

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

- 2015 **Founding Member, Khiyal Theatre Group**
- Co-founded a professional company growing out of the Shahid Beheshti University Theatre Association.
- 2014 – 2016 **Board Member, SBU Theatre Association**
- Planned and ran the association's productions and events; led its training programme for new members (2015–2016) and its introduction programme for new students (2014).